



has been inhabited for over 10,000 years. Named after the Count of Taquila, a Spanish nobleman who once owned it, Taquile has remained almost untouched by modern life: it has no cars, no paved roads, no electricity

or telecommunications—and no police force. There is virtually no crime on the island because the people live by a strict and simple moral code: *Ama suwa* (do not steal), *Ama llulla* (do not lie), *Ama quella* (do not be idle).

Carnival

There are three main festivals a year on Taquile: the first is around Easter; the second is when the harvest comes in; and the last is at new year. At these times the islanders bring out their finest costumes and jewelry, and create joyous celebrations with music, dancing, and feasting.



SACRED PLANT

A group of islanders gather and bless fresh coca leaves, which grow abundantly on Taquile. To make sure each journey they make is a peaceful one, they will offer these to the ancient gods of their lake and its surrounding mountains before they depart.



MANY LAYERS

At carnival time, Taquileños parade through the island playing festive music and performing special dances. As the women twirl, they reveal the full glory of their costumes, which have up to 16 layered skirts.

